

Trip plan — Budget Garda Loop (1 - 7 Sep 2026)

7-day camping loop from **Bergamo Airport (BGY)** through **Lake Iseo, Manerba del Garda / Salò** (west Garda), **Riva del Garda, Arco**, and **Valle dei Laghi** (Lago Toblino).

Travellers: 5 people, tent(s) + rental car (estate/SUV).

Driving rule: ≤ 100 km per calendar day on move days. Iseo→Riva is split over two days (~55 + ~50 km); return to BGY is direct from Riva.

Camps: three sites — **Camping del Sole** (Iseo, nights 1-2), **Camping La Rocca** (Manerba, night 3), **Camping Brione** (Riva, nights 4-6).

Budget: [BUDGET.md](#) — ~€997-1,837 excl. flights (7 days, 5 people).

Equipment: [../version-a/EQUIPMENT.md](#) — hiking kit + thin gloves for Day 5 ferrata; rent harness/helmet/lanyard locally.

Distances: [RESEARCH.md](#).

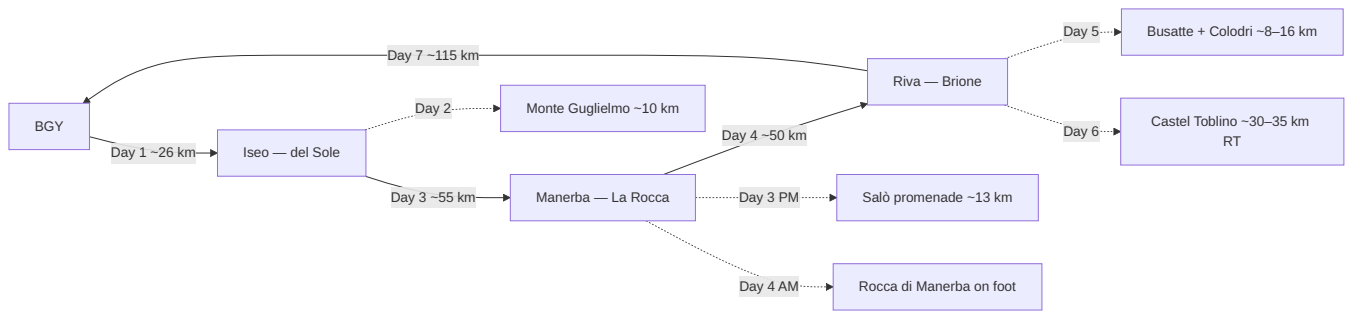
Continue to Dolomites? See [README — How this fits](#) or join [Dolomites Core](#) via Bressanone staging (~98 km from Sarche).

Calendar

Day	Date	Overnight	Main activity	Drive (km)
1	Tue 1 Sep	Camping del Sole, Iseo	Arrive BGY → lake	~26
2	Wed 2 Sep	Camping del Sole, Iseo	Monte Guglielmo hike	~0-15 local
3	Thu 3 Sep	Camping La Rocca, Manerba	Iseo → west Garda; Salò promenade	~55
4	Fri 4 Sep	Camping Brione, Riva	Rocca di Manerba AM → Riva waterfront PM	~50
5	Sat 5 Sep	Camping Brione, Riva	Busatte-Tempesta + Via Ferrata Colodri	~0-16 local
6	Sun 6 Sep	Camping Brione, Riva	Valle dei Laghi — Castel Toblino (day trip)	~30-35 RT
7	Mon 7 Sep	—	Riva → BGY direct	~115

Camping nights: 6 (2 × Iseo + 1 × Manerba + 3 × Riva).

Corridor map



Day 1 — Tue 1 Sep: Arrival at Lake Iseo

Schedule

Time	Activity
Morning / midday	Land BGY, collect rental car — car hire guide
Afternoon	Drive to Camping del Sole (~26 km, A4 Rovato exit)
Late afternoon	Easy lakeshore walk in Iseo town
Evening	Supermarket shop in Iseo — stock up for Days 1–3 (see Camp kitchen)

Costs today

Item	€
Car hire (daily share)	~€20–50
Campsite night 1	~€50–80
Groceries (first stock-up)	~€40–70

Watch

- Valley altitude ~200 m — no mountain exertion after travel.
- **Tomorrow is a full hiking day** at the same camp — pack lunch tonight.

Camp: [Camping del Sole](https://www.campingdelsole.it/en/) (<https://www.campingdelsole.it/en/>)

Day 2 — Wed 2 Sep: Monte Guglielmo (same camp)

Schedule

Time	Activity
07:30	Drive to Pescegallo / Castro trailhead (~10 km from camp)
Morning-afternoon	Monte Guglielmo via Rifugio Guglielmo — ~12-14 km, +1,100 m, 5-6 h; 360° views over Iseo and the Bergamo Alps
Late afternoon	Swim at camp beach OR short Iseo → Sulzano lakeshore walk (~8 km flat) if legs are done
Evening	Cook at camp; prep for transfer tomorrow (~55 km) — pack camp early

Easier fallback (same area): Corna Trentapassi ridge — ~6-8 km, +500 m, still panoramic.

Optional restaurant: [Ristorante Il Cantuccio](https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurants-g194882-Iseo_Province_of_Brescia_Lombardy.html) (https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurants-g194882-Iseo_Province_of_Brescia_Lombardy.html), Iseo — menu del giorno ~€18 (lake fish). See [Optional restaurants](#).

Costs today

Item	€
Campsite night 2	~€50-80
Fuel (local)	~€3-5

Watch

- Start **early** — little shade on the upper ridge.
- Carry **2 L+ water** per person; do not rely on the refugio being open.
- Weather backup: flat **Sulzano promenade** + optional **Monte Isola ferry** from Sulzano (~€9-11 RT/person).

Camp: [Camping del Sole](https://www.campingdelsole.it/en/) (https://www.campingdelsole.it/en/)

Day 3 — Thu 3 Sep: Iseo → Manerba del Garda

Schedule

Time	Activity
08:00	Pack camp, leave Iseo
10:00–10:30	Arrive Camping La Rocca , Manerba (~55 km via Brescia / Desenzano / Salò)
Midday	Check in, lake swim at camp
Afternoon	Drive to Salò (~13 km) — historic promenade, gelato, old-town stroll
Evening	Cook at camp OR optional dinner in Salò

Optional restaurant: [Osteria di Mezzo](https://www.tripadvisor.co.uk/Restaurants-g644254-Salo_Province_of_Brescia_Lombardy.html) (https://www.tripadvisor.co.uk/Restaurants-g644254-Salo_Province_of_Brescia_Lombardy.html), Salò — seasonal pasta, TripAdvisor top pick in Salò. See [Optional restaurants](#).

Costs today

Item	€
Fuel	~€10–15
Campsite night 3	~€50–80

Watch

- **West Garda** is warmer and more Mediterranean than Iseo — sunscreen for the afternoon.
- La Rocca sits at the **Rocca di Manerba** park trailhead — you hike it tomorrow before leaving.
- One night only at Manerba — keep camp setup simple.

Camp: [Camping La Rocca](https://www.laroccacamp.it/) (<https://www.laroccacamp.it/>)

Day 4 — Fri 4 Sep: Rocca di Manerba → Riva del Garda

Schedule

Time	Activity
07:30	Rocca di Manerba loop through the nature reserve — ~4-8 km, +200-350 m, 2-3 h; cliff-top views over all of lower Garda
10:30	Pack camp, leave Manerba
12:00–12:30	Arrive Camping Brione , Riva (~50 km along SS45bis Gardesana Occidentale)
Midday	Check in, lake swim
Afternoon	Easy waterfront walk Riva → Torbole
Evening	Cook at camp — save legs for Busatte and ferrata tomorrow

Costs today

Item	€
Fuel	~€10-15
Campsite night 4	~€55-85

Watch

- **Rocca trail** is exposed — start early; avoid if thunderstorms forecast.
- Gardesana road has **tunnels** — headlights on; can be slow in peak season (September is fine).
- You stay at Brione for **three nights** — pitch properly.

Camp: [Camping Brione](https://www.campingbrione.com/EN/) (https://www.campingbrione.com/EN/)

Day 5 — Sat 5 Sep: Busatte + Via Ferrata Colodri (same camp)

Schedule

Time	Activity
07:30	Busatte-Tempesta panoramic path (~10 km, 400 iron steps) — start early before heat on the steps
12:00	Lunch at camp
14:00	Drive to Arco / Prabi (~8 km)
Afternoon	Via Ferrata Colodri — cliff route 300 m above Lake Garda (~3–4 h total, grade A-B)
Evening	Optional stroll in Arco old town (free)

Via Ferrata Colodri — main “crazy” activity

Grade	Easy / A-B
Duration	~1 h on wire; 3–4 h total
Start	Car park at Camping Arco Prabi, Prabi (~8 km from Brione) — Visit Trentino (https://www.visitrentino.info/en/guide/tour/via-ferrata-colodri-colt_tour_8279464)
Gear	Rent in Arco — Mmove kit ~€16/day (https://360gardalife.com/en/activities/tours-excursions/viaferrata/colodri-lake-garda-alpine-guide-mmove/)
Who goes	Not everyone has to climb — 2–3 on the wire; others do Punta Larici (~3 km, +367 m) or swim at camp

Optional restaurant: [Osteria Degli Artisti](https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurants-g194883-Riva_Del_Garda_Province_of_Trento_Trentino_Alto_Adige.html) (https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurants-g194883-Riva_Del_Garda_Province_of_Trento_Trentino_Alto_Adige.html), Riva — homemade pasta, fair prices (~€15–25/person). See [Optional restaurants](#).

Costs today

Item	€
Campsite night 5	~€55–85
Ferrata kit × 5 (or × 2–3)	~€32–80
Fuel (local)	~€3–5

Watch

- **Busatte steps:** hot metal after 10:00 — do Busatte first.
- **Colodri:** dry weather only; vertigo-sensitive people skip it. Bring thin gloves.
- Weather backup: see [Appendix — Rio Sallagoni](#).

Camp: [Camping Brione](https://www.campingbrione.com/EN/) (https://www.campingbrione.com/EN/)

Day 6 — Sun 6 Sep: Valle dei Laghi day trip (same camp)

Schedule

Time	Activity
09:00	Drive Riva → Castel Toblino area (~ 30-35 km RT via Dro / SS45bis)
Morning	Castel Toblino lakeshore walk (~5-8 km, flat)
Afternoon	Seven Lakes stage I toward Monte Terlago (~14 km, hilly) OR short Covelo viewpoint hike
17:00	Return to Brione for last camp night; optional supermarket in Riva or Trento

Costs today

Item	€
Campsite night 6	~€55-85
Fuel	~€8-12

Watch

- Gateway to **A22** — if joining Dolomites tomorrow, shop in **Trento** (20 min from Toblino) for mountain supplies.
- Good day for **pesto pasta** at camp tonight — see [Camp kitchen](#).

Camp: [Camping Brione](https://www.campingbrione.com/EN/) (<https://www.campingbrione.com/EN/>)

Day 7 — Mon 7 Sep: Return to BGY

Schedule

Time	Activity
08:00	Pack camp, leave Riva
10:30-11:00	Arrive BGY (~115 km via SS240 → A22 → Brescia → A4)
Midday	Drop rental car, fly out

Why not via Iseo? Direct Riva → BGY saves repeating the 99 km Iseo leg. You already had two full Iseo days.

Options after Day 6

Option	What
A	Fly home Mon 7 Sep (this plan)
B	Continue north — Riva/Sarche → Bressanone (~98 km) Tue 8 Sep; join Dolomites Core

Costs today

Item	€
Fuel	~€18-28
Motorway / tolls	~€8-15
Car hire (final day)	included in 7-day rental

Camp kitchen (budget)

Cook **4-5 dinners** at camp; use optional restaurants on 1-2 nights. For 5 people, one gas stove + campfire (where allowed).

Meal	Idea	Shop where
Breakfast	Muesli + UHT milk, fruit, coffee (moka)	Iseo / Riva supermarket
Lunch (trail)	Pane + salame/coppa, apples, refill water	Stock up Day 1 at Iseo
Dinner 1 (Day 1)	Pasta aglio e olio + insalata	Iseo — cheap, one pot
Dinner 2 (Day 2)	Polenta (instant) + grilled zucchini + scamorza	Iseo camp
Dinner 3 (Day 3)	Risotto with frozen peas / stock cubes	Manerba camp market
Dinner 4 (Day 4)	Caprese (tomato, mozzarella, basil) + bread	Riva — shop on arrival
Dinner 5 (Day 5)	One-pot lentil soup + leftover pasta	Riva
Dinner 6 (Day 6)	Pesto pasta + cherry tomatoes	Riva / Trento stop on Toblino day
Snacks	Local cheese (Grana, Formaggella); wine €3-6 from discount aisle	Conad / Eurospin / Esselunga

Rule of thumb: 4 dinners cooked, 2 optional restaurant keeps food spend near the low end of [BUDGET.md](#).

Supermarket stops: Iseo (Days 1-2) → Manerba/Salò (Day 3) → Riva (Days 4-6) → Trento (Day 6, optional).

Optional restaurants (TripAdvisor)

Not included in base budget — pick 1–2 for a treat.

Day	Restaurant	Why	Link	Est. €/person
2	Ristorante Il Cantuccio , Iseo	Menu del giorno ~€18, lake fish, central	TripAdvisor Iseo (https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurants-g194882-Iseo_Province_of_Brescia_Lombardy.html)	€18–25
3	Osteria di Mezzo , Salò	Seasonal pasta, rustic charm — top Salò pick	TripAdvisor Salò (https://www.tripadvisor.co.uk/Restaurants-g644254-Salo_Province_of_Brescia_Lombardy.html)	€25–35
5 or 6	Osteria Degli Artisti , Riva	Homemade pasta, fair prices, ~4.5★	TripAdvisor Riva (https://www.tripadvisor.com/Restaurants-g194883-Riva_Del_Garda_Province_of_Trento_Trentino_Alto_Adige.html)	€15–25

Remember **pane e coperto** (bread/cover charge, ~€2–3/person) on restaurant bills.

Activity summary

Activity	Date	Type	From camp
Iseo lakeshore	1 Sep	Easy walk	on foot
Monte Guglielmo	2 Sep	Full-day mountain hike	~10 km drive
Salò promenade	3 Sep	Town / lake	~13 km from Manerba
Rocca di Manerba	4 Sep	Viewpoint / nature reserve	on foot from La Rocca
Riva waterfront	4 Sep	Lake walk	on foot
Busatte-Tempesta	5 Sep	Scenic hike (400 steps)	~15 min drive
Via Ferrata Colodri	5 Sep	Cliff ferrata (grade A-B)	~8 km
Punta Larici (optional)	5 Sep	Viewpoint	~10 km from Brione
Castel Toblino / Valle dei Laghi	6 Sep	Lake / hill walk	~30-35 km RT drive

Booking checklist

☐	Item	When	Link	Cost
☐	Car hire (7 days, estate/SUV)	ASAP	Dolomites Core car hire guide	€200-490
☐	Camping del Sole (1-2 Sep, 2 nights)	ASAP	campingdelsole.it (https://www.campingdelsole.it/en/)	~€100-160
☐	Camping La Rocca (3 Sep, 1 night)	ASAP	laroccacamp.it (https://www.laroccacamp.it/)	~€50-80
☐	Camping Brione (4-6 Sep, 3 nights)	ASAP	campingbrione.com (https://www.campingbrione.com/EN/)	~€165-255
☐	Ferrata kit × 5 sets (Day 5)	1-2 weeks before	Mmove Arco (https://360gardalife.com/en/activities/tours-excursions/viaferrata/colodri-lake-garda-alpine-guide-mmmove/)	~€16/person

Suggested pre-trip viewing

1. [Busatte-Tempesta — Trentino.com](https://www.trentino.com/en/leisure-activities/mountains-and-hiking/hiking-in-spring/busatte-tempesta-panorama-path/) (https://www.trentino.com/en/leisure-activities/mountains-and-hiking/hiking-in-spring/busatte-tempesta-panorama-path/)
2. [Via Ferrata Colodri — Visit Trentino](https://www.visittrentino.info/en/guide/tour/via-ferrata-colodri-colt_tour_8279464) (https://www.visittrentino.info/en/guide/tour/via-ferrata-colodri-colt_tour_8279464)
3. [Brooke Beyond — beginner ferrata guide](https://brookebeyond.com/via-ferrata-in-the-italian-dolomites) (https://brookebeyond.com/via-ferrata-in-the-italian-dolomites)
4. [Rocca di Manerba — Visit Manerba](https://visitmanerba.it/) (https://visitmanerba.it/)

Full research: [RESEARCH.md](#).

Appendix — Weather backup: Via Ferrata Rio Sallagoni

If Colodri is wet or the group prefers a shorter canyon route, swap the afternoon ferrata on **Day 5**.

Grade	Easy — short canyon ferrata near Arco
Duration	~2–3 h total
Gear	Same kit rental as Colodri in Arco — 360gardalife (https://360gardalife.com/en/activities/tours-excursions/viaferrata/)
When	Better in overcast/cool conditions than Colodri's exposed east face

Cheaper backup (no ferrata): Grotta Cascata Varone — waterfall inside a cave, **€7/person**, ~12 km from Brione — [cascata-varone.com](https://www.cascata-varone.com/en/) (https://www.cascata-varone.com/en/).

Suggested viewing: [Via Ferrata Colodri — Visit Trentino](https://www.visittrentino.info/en/guide/tour/via-ferrata-colodri-colt_tour_8279464) (https://www.visittrentino.info/en/guide/tour/via-ferrata-colodri-colt_tour_8279464) · [Brooke Beyond — beginner ferrata guide](https://brookebeyond.com/via-ferrata-in-the-italian-dolomites) (https://brookebeyond.com/via-ferrata-in-the-italian-dolomites)